

Hawksmoor

Nicholas Hawksmoor (1661–1736) was a leading architect of the English Baroque, along with Wren and Vanbrugh. He helped design some of the finest buildings of the period, including St Paul's Cathedral and Hampton Court Palace, but also made his own singular contributions.

Raised in Nottinghamshire, Hawksmoor became clerk to Wren at age 18. From c.1700, he helped Vanbrugh at Castle Howard (where he designed the Mausoleum, opposite) and Blenheim Palace. He designed London churches, including Christ Church, Spitalfields and St George's in Bloomsbury, its pyramidal steeple a clue to his unusual taste for pagan symbols. He also designed university colleges – notably in the heart of Oxford, where he added a Gothic flavour to All Soul's College (1716–35) to integrate it with the adjacent medieval buildings, and conceived the Clarendon Building (1711–15) in the neoclassical style. One of his last commissions was for Westminster Abbey, where he designed the great towers flanking the western front.

